

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'Endowed with the Limbs of All Buddhas'

Ārya-sarvabuddhāṅgavatī-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 513 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་སངས་རྒྱལ་ཐམས་ཅད་ཀྱི་ལྷན་ལག་དང་ལན་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའི་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 513 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-sarvabuddhāṅgavatī-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Phakpa Sangye Tamché Kyi Yenlak Dangdenpa Zhejawa'i Zung, rendered in English as "The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Endowed with the Limbs of All Buddhas." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, a class of texts centered on sacred ritual formulas believed to confer protection and spiritual benefit. The text opens with the Buddha addressing the four guardian kings on the banks of the Gaṅgā River, teaching that human beings face four great fears — old age, sickness, decline, and death — with the fear of death being the most fearsome and inescapable of all. Against these terrors, the dhāraṇī is presented as a powerful means of protection and liberation, embodying the qualities of all buddhas.

In the language of India: Ārya-sarvabuddhāṅgavatī-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Endowed with the Limbs of All Buddhas."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling on the great bank of the Gaṅgā River together with the four guardians of the world. At that time the Blessed One addressed the four great kings, Vaiśravaṇa and the others, saying this:

"O great kings, these four great fears arise for men, for women, for boys, and for girls. What are the four? They are: old age, sickness, decline, and death. And among these there is one great fear — the great fear of the lord of death — which comes without warning, for which there is no remedy, and which follows always in pursuit.

"O great kings, the antidote to that one great fear I shall now proclaim here."

Then the four great kings addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, because the Blessed One has granted life and taken beings under his care, this day we have found a good and excellent find."

Then the Blessed One turned his mind toward the east and, with the sound of a bell, summoned all the Tathāgatas, saying: "May all those Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, who for the sake of sentient beings, out of their compassion, have manifested complete and perfect awakening in unsurpassed, perfect, and complete enlightenment — may they be my allies. Thus, having been blessed by the blessing of all buddhas, we shall here completely avert untimely death for all sentient beings, and we shall turn the wheel of Dharma a second time, turning it as it was turned before."

In the same way he summoned all the Tathāgatas of the south, the west, the north, the zenith, and the nadir, saying: "May all those Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas, who for the sake of sentient beings, out of their compassion, have manifested complete and perfect awakening in unsurpassed, perfect, and complete enlightenment — may they be my allies."

Likewise, to the Tathāgatas of the intermediate directions he spoke thus: "So that these beings may be fully accomplished in long life, strength, and radiance, and so that the fear of untimely death may not arise — may all buddhas be my allies."

Then, as many world systems in the ten directions as appeared before the eyes of the buddhas, all those world systems were filled with buddhas, the Blessed Ones, like sesame seeds packed in a jar. Having accepted the role of allies to the Tathāgata, all those Tathāgatas together spoke these words:

Tadyathā: cālā cālā cale, vinati, svastike, cakrāṅgati, praśamantu, sarva-roga-anatre, kunaṭe mahākunaṭe, care care re, he māgiri, he māgaury, he mānīṣuntī, he māṣiṣi, kaurave kauravabe, he kurare, kurare, kumati, viṣasamaṇe, śiṣubi, cale cale, vicalē, mā vilamba humu humu svāhā.

All the lords of secrets (Vajrapāṇi and those of his order), however many they were, also sat in the presence of all the Tathāgatas and said: "Hūṃ hūṃ si si svāhā."

When these words were uttered, all the Tathāgatas became invisible.

Then the Great King Vaiśravaṇa (guardian of the north) addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, I too will protect beings by the blessing of the Tathāgata. I will turn back untimely death."

Tadyathā: śvete śvete, le li li.

The noble Jātaka also spoke: māṭaṅge māṭaṅge, māṭaṅginī, śūmāśāmu.

Virūḍhaka (guardian of the south) also spoke: cāre cāre re svāhā.

Virūpākṣa (guardian of the west) also spoke: bālampipa.

Then the Blessed One declared: "O Great Kings, whoever recites this dhāraṇī, seen by all the buddhas, once each day, that son of good family or daughter of good family should be regarded with the perception of a Teacher. That son of good family or daughter of good family will not fall into any of the three lower destinies. This will bring benefit to the lives of all sentient beings. Whoever recites it aloud once each day for the sake of all sentient beings, and whoever reads it, will have no fear of untimely death. No severe illness will arise in their body. Water will not bring them to their appointed death, nor fire, nor weapons, nor poison, nor a falling precipice. Know that wherever the sons of the Victors recite this dhāraṇī, that place is attended to by all the buddhas and bodhisattvas. Whoever writes it out or undertakes to have it written will have rendered full service to the Buddha Bhagavāns in every act of honor due them. Why is this? Because the Tathāgatas have declared: serving sentient beings is itself serving the buddhas. If someone writes this out and wears it on their limbs, all their limbs will be protected."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the four Great Kings together with the entire assembly, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

The noble dhāraṇī called Endowed with the Limbs of All the Buddhas is complete.

Translated by the Indian scholars Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, and the great translator-monk Yeshé Dé, revised according to the new language standard and established as the final edition.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "lords of secrets" translates gSang ba'i bdag po, a standard epithet of Vajrapāṇi and the class of Vajra-holders he leads; the plural here indicates his entire retinue.

The mantra syllables are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit and are left in their liturgical form as is standard for dhāraṇī texts; minor phonological variants from attested Sanskrit forms are a normal feature of Tibetan dhāraṇī transmission.

The phrase "turning the wheel of Dharma a second time" likely alludes to the Mahāyāna doctrine of the second turning of the wheel, associated with the Prajñāpāramitā teachings, though in this ritual context it may simply mean a renewed proclamation of the Dharma for the

benefit of beings threatened by untimely death.

- The passage includes four of the five mantric utterances attributed to the four Great Kings. The text as it stands assigns Virūḍhaka to "Yul 'khor srung" and Virūpākṣa to "Mig mi bzang," which are the standard Tibetan epithets for the guardians of the south and west respectively; the translation renders these by their Sanskrit names as is conventional. The utterance attributed to the noble Jātaka figure sitting between the kings is unusual and likely represents a minor deity of that name appearing in the assembly rather than a reference to the Jātaka literature; it is rendered by the Tibetan epithet 'phags skyes po, meaning "noble-born one," which in context is a divine name rather than a title.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.